But, ja, it was quite funny. The locals certainly found it bladdy amusing, as everyone smokes the stuff there, even though it's illegal.

While we're on the subject, and in case you're wondering, you should know that while alcohol is available all over the show, recreational drugs are not part of the cricket scene at all – especially now. Back then there weren't so many drug tests, but these days you probably pee into a test tube more often than you do into the toilet bowl. The rules are also a lot stricter on what we can and cannot use.

The guys tend to get the doctor's clearance first before they take or use anything. It's just not worth it to take any chances. Obviously many of us love a few drinks, and quite a few of us smoke the odd cigarette, but I certainly don't know of anyone who does drugs. If you test positive for illegal drug use, you are banned for life. No one is stupid enough to take that risk.

The Pakistan racial slur

I may have said and done some things I regret in my life, but calling those particular Pakistani cricket fans a bunch of animals and inviting them to make their way back home was not one of them. The incident occurred during the Proteas' first Test against Pakistan at Centurion Park in 2007.

For some or other reason, the fans – a combination of South Africans and native Pakistanis – were going ape-shit. I've never seen fans misbehave to such an extent at a cricket match. For the first two days they went really crazy, as if they were bladdy possessed. They made a huge noise and even kicked Rashard, my son, and his mom, Liesl, out of their seats when they took over the area next to the pitch entrance that leads up to the changing room, where they wanted to shake hands with, or throw idiotic insults at, the players as they left the field.

All of us Proteas were getting pretty irritated, and unfortunately the stump microphones picked up our displeasure. I was standing at gully, Graeme Smith was at slip and we were both looking at these morons. We agreed that a little verbal retaliation was in order. 'Stop acting like a bunch of fucking animals!' I said. I can't remember what Graeme said.

Then, after the close of play, the team was notified that a complaint of racism had been laid against one of the Proteas. Me. Typical. I mean, we all had had something to say about those supporters on the day, but after listening to the recording, it was decided that mine was the one voice that